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6 **Research Topic:** Assessing the Social and Educational Impact of Not Having Enough Access to Language for Deaf Children in South Asia

Title: Assessing the Social and Educational Impact of Not Having Enough Access to Language for Deaf Children in South Asia

Research Problem:

Many deaf children born to hearing families feel secluded and have very scarce means of communication because of their lack of access to language. Deaf children, because they are unable to take in language audibly, communicate through visual aids such as gestures and signs; However, in a hearing world where different conditions are stigmatized, many parents are not willing to learn a new language. Particularly in South Asia, people who are deaf are often thought of as incapable of learning because they cannot hear, and facilities can not or will not provide accessible education. A lack of ways to communicate can lead to a decline in social skills which can even further lessen their chances of accessing the same opportunities as other hearing children.

Existing Literature:

Previous studies show the necessity for language and communication among deaf children. For example, Wyatt C. Hall [1] notes that the lack of language access can result in lower quality of life and have other negative implications. In his studies of deaf children born to hearing families, Meristo [2] explains how deaf children can often rely too heavily on their parents, which can hinder their ability to function when they become an adult. Murray, Snoddon and Hall [3] emphasize the limited amount of exposure to sign language given to deaf children within Asia. Abhinmayu Sharma [4] documents the very little attention Deaf and Hard of Hearing policies received by scholars in India. While researchers such as Drusilla Gibbs [5] state that USAID provides resources for deaf children, they have failed to mention if the project has reached Asia, but explains how children in South Asia often do not get the same learning opportunities as hearing children.

Research Question:

To what extent does language deprivation affect deaf children in South Asia born to hearing families in terms of social skills and educational development?

Hypotheses:

The lack of signed language and communication will lead to a lower level of social skills and educational development among deaf children.

Methodology:

This study utilizes a mixed-methods approach to understand the measurable outcomes as well as the qualitative experiences of deaf children.

Quantitative component:

- A quasi-experimental design will be used to compare two groups of deaf adults: One who grew up with access to sign language and one who did not.
- A survey on the level of education received as a child sent to hearing adults and deaf adults
- A sample size of 100 people, (50 per group) will be used to analyze this

Qualitative component:

- Interviews with parents of deaf children who do not use sign language regarding how the children are making social connections
- Assessing the social skills of deaf children without access to sign language using the Minnesota Social Skills Checklist for Students Who are Deaf/Hard of Hearing in a classroom setting.

Ethical Considerations:

- Parental consent to record and observe their children in their day-to-day lives
- Anonymity and Confidentiality if wanted will be obtained
- Full information given regarding the motives of this study

Research Topic:

The topic is very urgent, and needs to be brought to attention more often. In South Asian communities, being deaf is often stigmatized, and many children are thought to be incapable of learning because of their deafness, which can lead to a sense of helplessness. By evaluating the extent to which not having a language to communicate with affects the social and emotional well-being of deaf children, this research offers valuable insight into the necessity for sign language. This study would serve as a way to educate parents in South Asian communities on the utility and need for signed language.

References:

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[5]Borgen Project, "Deaf Children in Poverty: A Right to an Education," The Borgen Project. Accessed: Sep. 20, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://borgenproject.org/deaf-children-in-poverty/

[6]Ashoka, "Creating a Signing World," Changemakers. Accessed: Sep. 20, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://medium.com/change-maker/creating-a-signing-world-d4691426e58a